

**LABORATORY ACTIVITY NO. 3.3.14****Using the Printer**

This lab activity guides the student through the process of setting up and managing a printer within a Windows 11 environment. It covers connecting the printer, allowing Windows to install necessary drivers, accessing various printer settings and preferences, and managing print jobs through the print queue.

I. OBJECTIVES

Upon completion of this laboratory exercise, students are expected to and meet the following intended learning outcomes:

Activity Objectives	Intended Learning Outcomes		
	ILO1	ILO2	ILO3
1) successfully connect and initiate driver installation for a printer, ensuring it is recognized and ready for use within the Windows 11 operating system.	•	•	
2) navigate and configure printer settings and preferences using the Printers & scanners section of the Windows 11 Settings app, identifying options such as duplex printing and color management.	•	•	
3) effectively manage print jobs by utilizing the print queue in Windows 11, including pausing, resuming, and canceling print tasks.	•	•	

Where:

- ILO1 – Exhibit thorough demonstration of the concept
- ILO2 – Being able to perform the activity independently
- ILO3 – Design and evaluate emerging IT solutions

II. DISCUSSION

- **Device Setup:** This includes the installation and uninstallation of peripherals, emphasizing the role of Plug-and-Play (PnP) and device drivers in this process.
- **Display Devices:** The module covers different display technologies such as LCD, LED, OLED, and Plasma. It also details key display characteristics like refresh rate, resolution, aspect ratio, brightness, contrast ratio, and response time, along with the configuration of multiple displays.



- **Multimedia Devices:** Discussions include sound devices (sound cards, speakers, headphones, and microphones), as well as webcams and video cameras.
- **Printers:** Various types of printers are covered, including inkjet, laser, thermal, and impact printers. Key features such as duplexing, speed, color capabilities, and memory are discussed. Maintenance aspects like ink/toner replacement, calibration, and cleaning are also included, along with different printer interfaces (USB, Ethernet, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth).
- **Scanners:** The document describes flatbed and sheet-fed scanner types. It also covers the process of scanning documents, mentioning interfaces like TWAIN and Windows Image Acquisition (WIA), and common output file formats such as JPG, TIFF, PDF, and the use of Optical Character Recognition (OCR).
- **Digital Cameras:** The module touches upon digital cameras and methods for transferring images from cameras to a PC.

III. MATERIALS

A Windows 11 installed computer system.

IV. PROCEDURE

For this activity, you will execute the provided step-by-step instructions. As you complete each step, capture a screenshot of the resulting output or completed action that directly demonstrates successful execution of that instruction. Paste each screenshot into the designated area within your lab document.

Important Considerations:

- **Driver Installation:** Windows 11 typically manages printer driver installation automatically through Plug and Play. However, for optimal performance or advanced features, it is advisable to check the printer manufacturer's website for the latest drivers and any accompanying software.
- **Accessing Printer Settings:** In Windows 11, the primary interface for managing printers is the **Settings** app. You can navigate to `Start > Settings > Bluetooth & devices > Printers & scanners` to find your installed printers and their management options. While the classic Control Panel's "Devices and Printers" applet is still accessible, the Settings app provides a more streamlined experience for modern Windows versions.
- **Printer Preferences:** Within the printer's management options, you can access "Printing preferences" to configure specific features of your printer, such as color

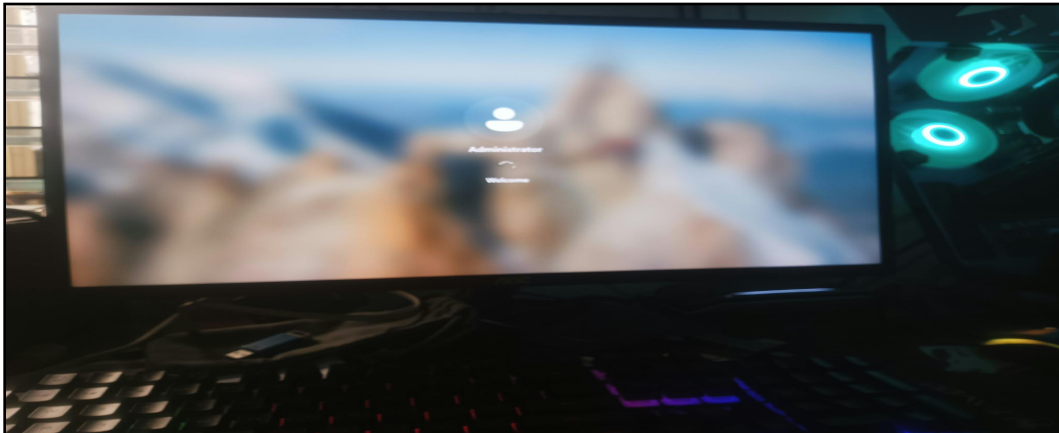


printing, duplex (two-sided) printing, print quality, and paper handling. The available options will vary based on your printer model.

- **Print Queue Management:** You will learn to open and manage the print queue. This allows you to pause, resume, or cancel print jobs, which is essential for troubleshooting or controlling print order.
- **Physical Setup and Supplies:** Before beginning the lab, ensure your printer is physically connected to your computer (via USB or network), powered on, and loaded with paper and sufficient ink or toner.
- **Manufacturer Documentation:** Always consult the printer's specific documentation for any unique setup requirements or advanced features not covered in general Windows settings.

Steps:

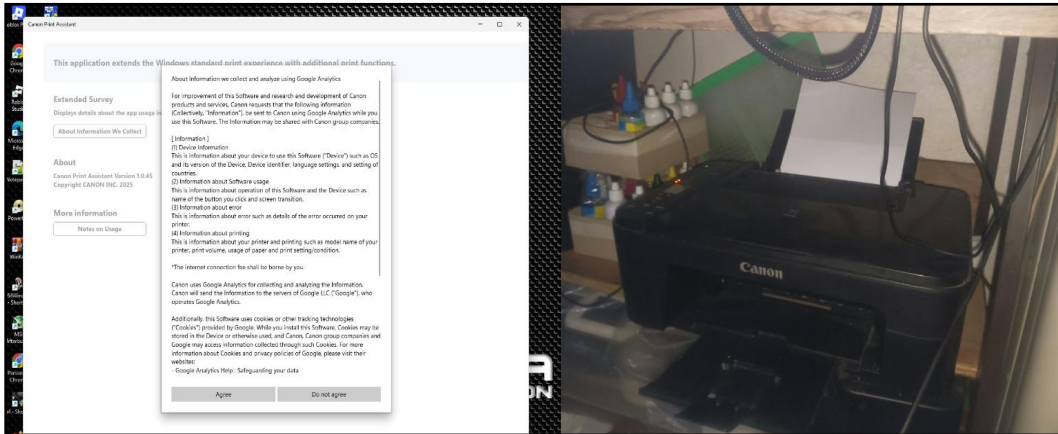
1. If necessary, start your computer and sign in.



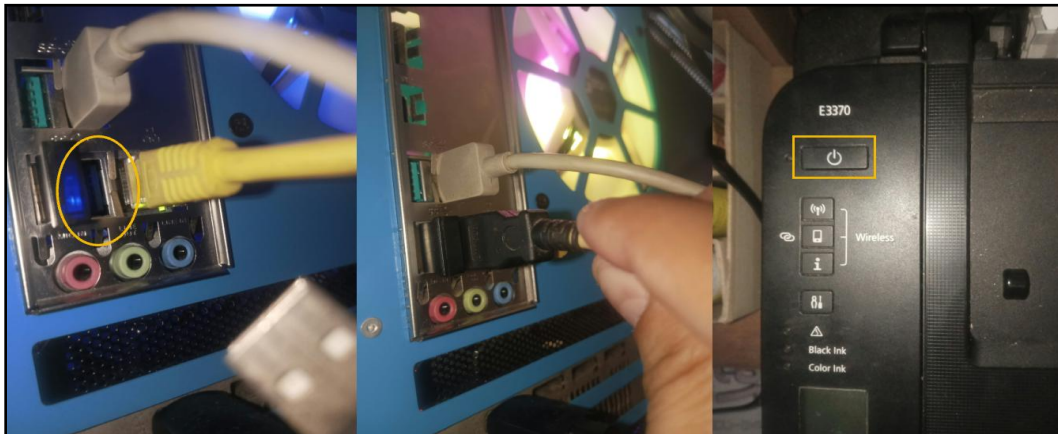
2. Read the documentation that accompanies the printer and complete any steps required to prepare the printer before plugging it in. The printer may come with setup software that you should install first. You should also check that the printer



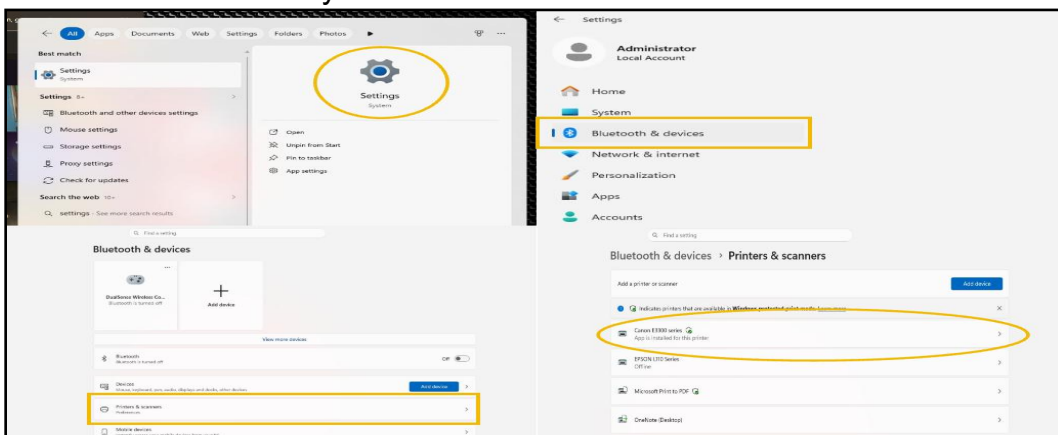
is loaded with paper properly.



3. Connect the printer using the appropriate port, then switch it on. Allow Windows to install the driver.

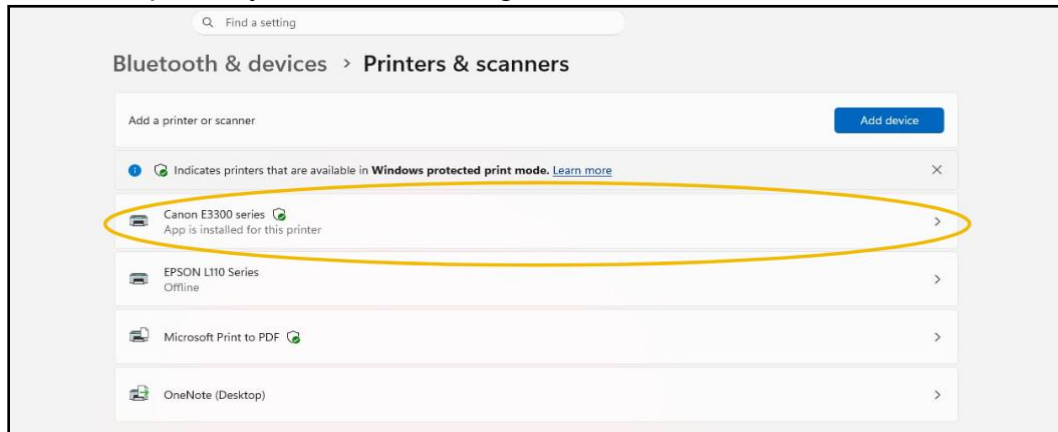


4. When the printer has been installed, open **Settings > Bluetooth & devices > Printers & scanners**. The printer should be listed here, and it might be set as the default if it's the only one installed.

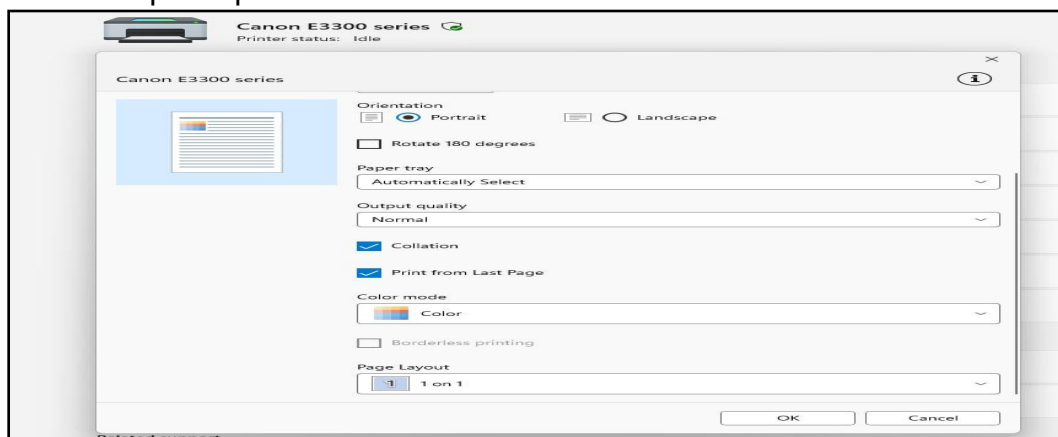




5. Select the printer you wish to manage from the list.



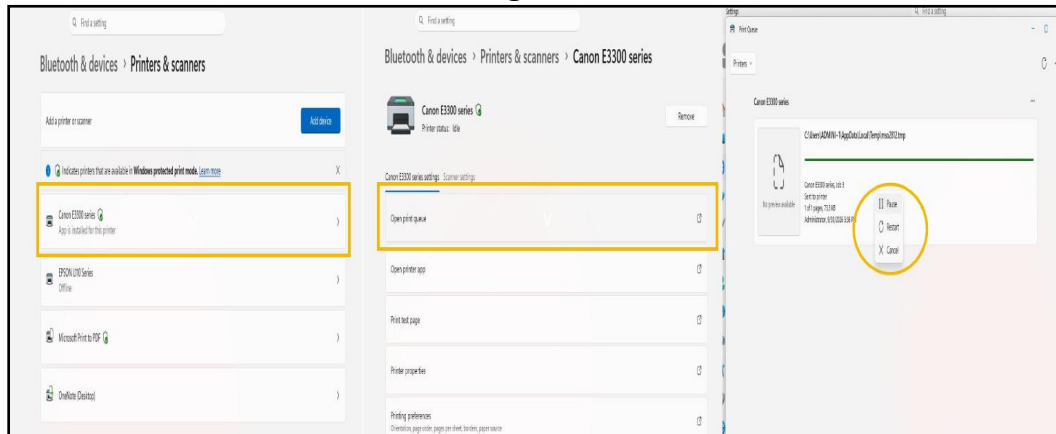
6. Click the **Printing preferences** link. Browse the tabs in the dialog that opens to explore the features available on your printer. For example, find out if there are color or duplex options.



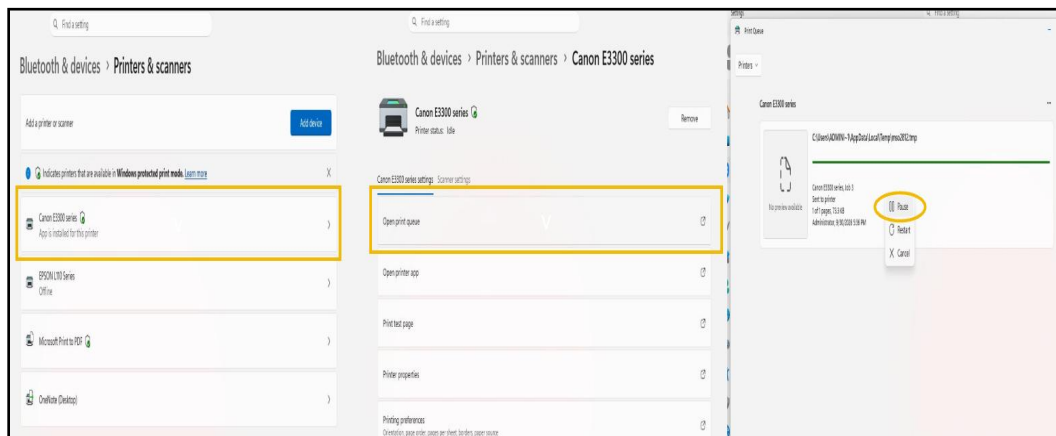
7. To pause the printer queue, navigate to **Settings > Bluetooth & devices > Printers & scanners**, select your printer, and then click **Open print queue**. Alternatively, you can right-click the printer icon in the notification area of the taskbar and select **Open print queue**. In the print queue window, from the



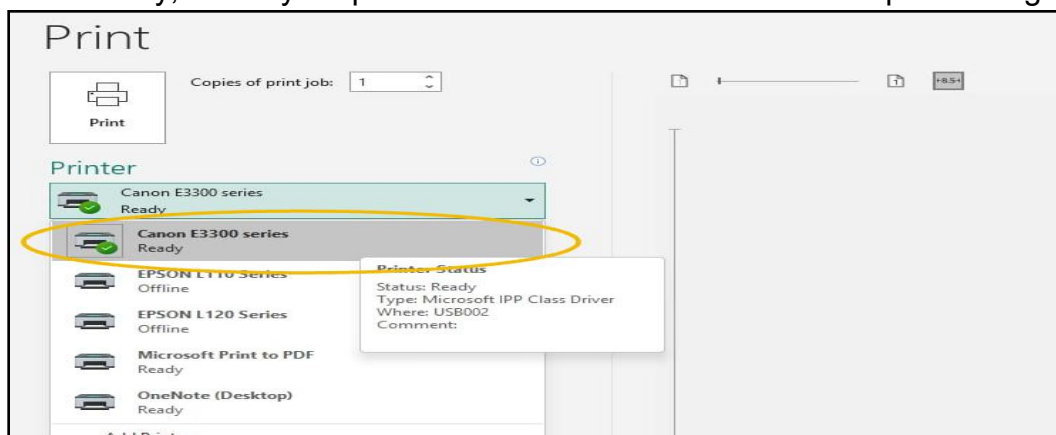
Printer menu, select Pause Printing.



8. Right-click one of the picture files you created earlier (or any document/image) and select **Print**.

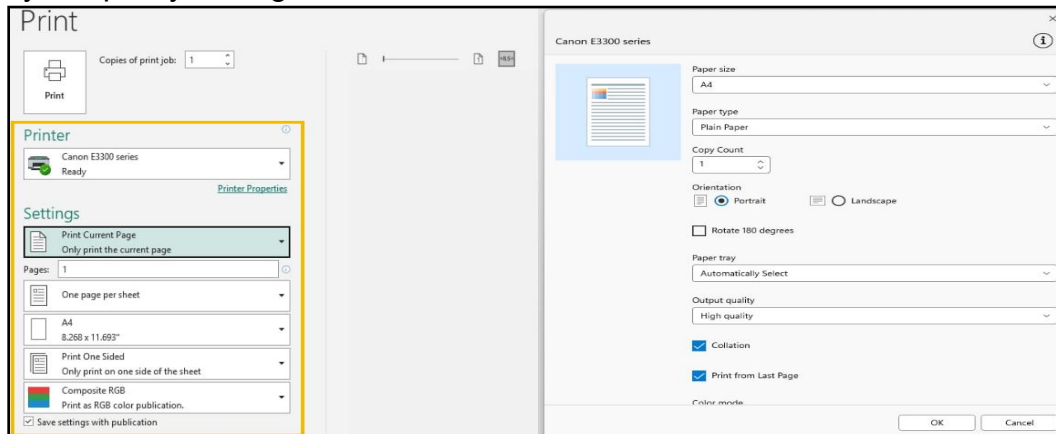


9. If necessary, select your printer from the **Printer** list box in the print dialog.

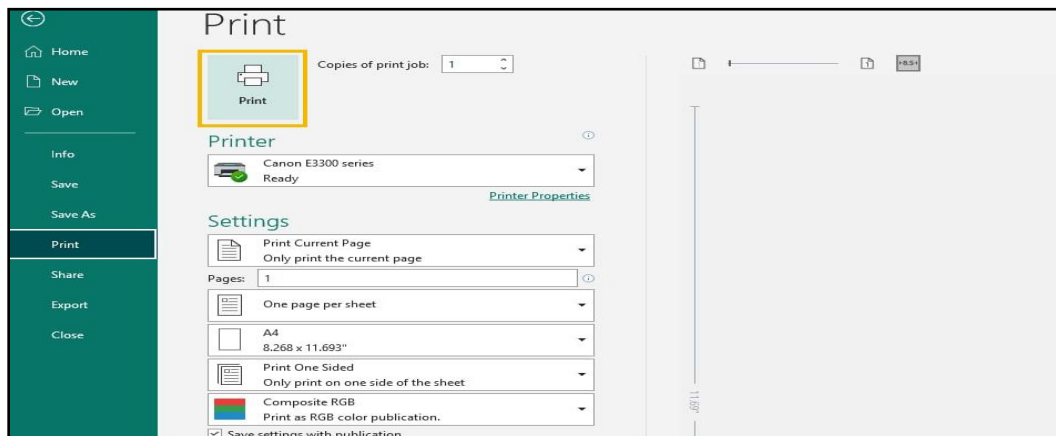




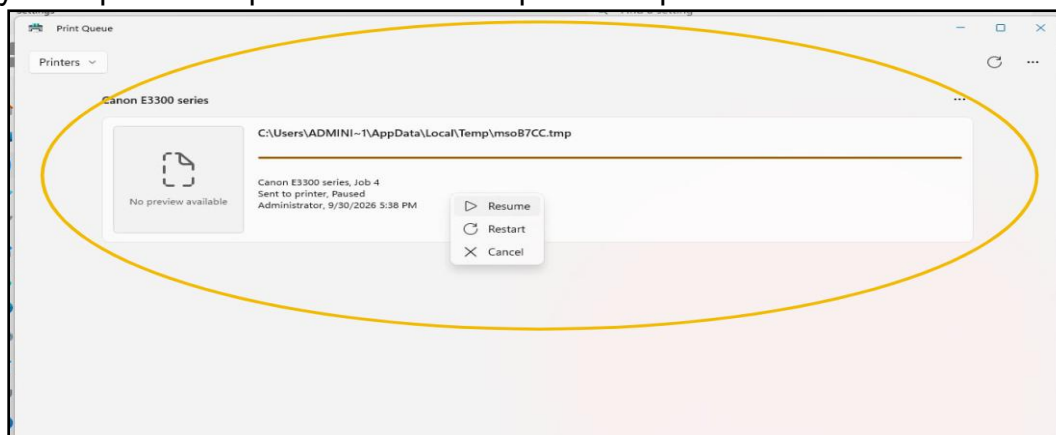
10. Choose your desired print options, such as "Full Page Photo" or other layout/quality settings.



11. Click **Print**.



12. Switch to the print queue window and note that the job waits in the queue while the printer is paused. Right-click the job and note the options in the shortcut menu (e.g., Pause, Resume, Cancel, Properties), but do not select any of them yet. Unpause the printer to allow the picture to print.





V. REFLECTION:

Upon successful completion of "Lab 3.3.14: Using the Printer," write a comprehensive reflection (between 150-250 words) addressing the following points:

- **Learning Outcomes:** What new knowledge or skills did you acquire or reinforce regarding the printer?
- **Challenges and Solutions:** Describe any difficulties or unexpected issues you encountered during the lab. How did you overcome them, or what steps would you take to resolve them in the future?
- **Real-world Relevance:** How do the skills and understanding gained in this lab relate to real-world scenarios, either in your personal life or a professional IT context?
- **Critical Thinking:** If you had to use an internet image for any step, explain why you couldn't perform the action physically and how finding the image contributed to your understanding.

In this lab I learned how to connect a printer and let Windows 11 install the driver automatically through Plug and Play. I also learned to find my printer under Settings > Bluetooth & devices > Printers & scanners and to explore Printing preferences, such as color and duplex options. Finally, I practiced managing the print queue by pausing the printer, watching a job wait, and resuming it so it printed.

The only difficulty was a little confusion with the layout settings and printer properties. The interfaces were different from what I expected, and options like page layout, duplex, and print quality sat in different tabs depending on the dialog and the printer model. I solved this by going through each tab one by one and comparing Printing preferences with Printer properties until I found the right settings. In the future, I would check the manufacturer's documentation first, since available options vary by printer.

These skills are useful at home, where I may need to set up a printer or fix a stuck print job. They are also useful in an IT job, where installing printers, changing default settings, and clearing a jammed print queue are common help desk tasks.

I did not use any internet image in this lab. I could do every step directly on my own computer and printer, so I did not need outside pictures. Seeing the real screens myself, including the differences in interface, helped me understand the settings better than a sample image would have.